

The Twente Canal Drought Dilemma

Project: Transdisciplinary Master-Insert at the Univeristy of Twente
Client: Port of Twente
Problem: Increasing drought in the Twente Canal
Solution: Developing a workshop to foster communication

Questions that framed the problem:

1. What are the consequences of low water levels?
2. Who are the stakeholders and what do they need?
3. How does communication between these stakeholders currently take place?

Activities: Interviews with relevant stakeholders: skippers, farmers, industrial site managers, government representatives.
Developing a stakeholder map

Findings: The biggest challenge was the way (lack of) stakeholder communication

Outcome: A workshop focused on bringing relevant parties together, helping them empathise with each other and how they deal with low water levels.

Goal: Create a space of understanding and feeling each other's perspectives and to challenge existing assumptions in order to spark new ideas.

We developed a practical, hands-on workshop that turned endless discussions into more focused and effective communication.

The workshop in visuals

Phase 1: Getting to know each other



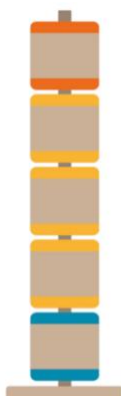
1

A custom-made puzzle of the Twente Canal was made as an icebreaker, the puzzle later formed the core of the workshop.



2

Participants introduced themselves using a "totem", noting their profession, what they had in common with others, and their reason for using the Twente Canal.



Beroep

Hierop werd het beroep van de deelnemer geschreven.

Overeenkomsten

Hierop werden de overeenkomsten tussen de verschillende deelnemers opgeschreven. Deze werden verzameld door 3 speeddate rondes.

Belangrijkste gebruiksredenen

Hierop werd de belangrijkste gebruiksredenen in betrekking tot het Twentekanaal opgeschreven.



3

The totems were placed on the puzzle at the location matching each person's role. For example, a skipper placed their totem on the canal, while a farmer placed theirs on the surrounding countryside.



4

To practise solving a problem together, participants got a mini-challenge: how would they jointly defend their interests if plans arose to turn the Twente Canal into a beach resort?

Twente Beach Resort, geen eten op je bord!



Gebruik van het kanaal

- Duurzaamheid
- Verstoring gebied
- Desinvestering:
 - Verruiming TK
 - Sluizen
- Ontlasting wegnnet
- Economisch belang: inkomsten
- Intermodaal transport
- Verstingsklimaat bedrijven
- Toename werkloosheid

Uniek verkoopargument

- Bereikbaarheid: multi modaal
- Ruimte om te ondernemen
- Onderwijs / onderzoek
- Uniek landschap
- Verduurzaming havens



Onderteken de petitie en help ons het Twente Kanaal behouden!

Phase 2: Addressing challenges and shaping solutions



5

Three challenges related to the drought in the Twente Canal were written on puzzle pieces. Using blocks, participants rated their importance on a scale from 0–3 to explain their priorities to each other.



0 waarde blokken
Hierbij is het fijn als de uitdaging wordt aangekaart maar dit is niet noodzakelijk.



1 waarde blok
Dit is een uitdaging die moet worden aangekaart, maar niet direct het belangrijkste is.



2 waarde blokken
Dit is een belangrijke uitdaging die besproken moet worden.



3 waarde blokken
Dit een zeer belangrijke uitdaging die direct invloed heeft op het gebruik van het kanaal.



6

The challenges were connected with “bridges” and grouped by puzzle-piece colour. This revealed unexpected links and encouraged new ways of thinking.



7

The smaller puzzles were then broken apart and reassembled into one large puzzle. Everyone was challenged to communicate and make connections by building bridges between the different challenges.

Workshop outcomes

- Themes like accessibility, economic interests, sustainability and collaboration are closely intertwined.
- Drought is largely a consequence of climate change
- Joint action, shared awareness and common interests are essential to address drought.
- There is a need to collaborate at regional, national and even European level to achieve sustainable solutions.

My role

- Active leadership during the preparation
- Designing the puzzle and other supporting materials (graphic design, laser cutting, painting)

Lessons learnt

- Communicating with industry is crucial to truly understand problems and tackle real-world wicked issues
- The power of physical objects and activities to communicate ideas
- Letting project requirements guide the work instead of perfectionism